

CURRENT AFFAIRS



INDIA - TURKEY
NEW LOW



MINI CAPSULE

05-05-2017

10/18th Week





TURKEY

AT A GLANCE

- Official ... Republic of Turkey
- Major ... Anatolian Peninsula
- Minor ... Balkan Peninsula
- It is successor to the Ottoman Empire
- Republic of Turkey established on 29th Oct, 1923.
- First President... Kemal Ataturk
- Early member of NATO

- Capital ... Ankara
- Largest city ... Istanbul
- Official language ... Turkish
- Largest minority group ... Kurds
- Currency ... Turkish Lira
- HDI ... 0.761 (high)
- Per capita Nominal GDP ... \$ 9,562
- Predominantly Sunni Muslim



TURKEY ... IN RECENT TIMES



Recep Tayyip Erdoğan
President of Turkey

Kurds are the largest minority group in the country.

- 1 Erdoğan became more authoritative after his narrow win in the referendum primarily because of hinterland small towns, just like Donald Trump victory and Brexit.
- 2 He is becoming the most authoritative/ dictatorial President
- 3 Country is moving away from secularism
- 4 After the failed coup last year, several people were arrested and several government officials were dismissed.
- 5 For several years, it has been trying for membership of the European Union, but the European Union may not embrace Turkey now.
- 6 It is a member of NATO.
- 7 It is now teamed up with Russia to solve the problem of Syria.
- 8 Sunni dominated country and Erdoğan wants to crown himself as the leader of the Islamist world.



INDIA – TURKEY ... NEW LOW ↓

- 1 He suggested a **multilateral dialogue on Kashmir**, even **offering to mediate** between India and Pakistan and it is against our stand on the issue of Kashmir, which is essentially an issue of terrorism, and the dispute with Pakistan must be settled bilaterally.
- 2 He only referred to, **India-related terrorism as Naxalism**. He remained unwilling to acknowledge the **cross-border nature of the terror threat** that India faces.
- 3 On **India's entry into the Nuclear Suppliers Group**, he tried to push the case of Pakistan's along with India's.
- 4 He was willing to support bid for a permanent seat in the **United Nations Security Council** for India as he called for major institutional reforms. But, Turkey is a **member of the group called Uniting for Consensus**, which **opposes expansion of permanent membership in the UNSC**.
- 5 He may not be happy with **Vice-President's visit to Armenia**, a country which accuses Turkey of having killed an estimated 1.5 million Armenians during World War I.
- 6 He was also not happy with Cypriot President's visit to New Delhi and the Cyprus President requested India to tell Turkey that the status quo on the territorial dispute on his island nation is unacceptable.







Recep Tayyip Erdoğan

President of Turkey



Narendra Modi

Prime Minister of India

INDIA – TURKEY ... GOING FORWARD!

- 1 New Delhi cannot ignore Turkey as it is a major regional power in West Asia, but at the same time we cannot allow Ankara to define the contours of this relationship.
- 2 If Turkey is in need of India, then it should be sensitive to the core issues of India.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar

V. Dayakar James

Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

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